

LinkedIn Growth Plan

Higher connection acceptance · More inbound requests · Reaching a US audience

Prepared for **Arun Manoharan** · Founding Team, GTM @ Ratio · June 2026

Note on sourcing: The specific YouTube video was unreachable from the research environment (blocked), so these recommendations are reconstructed from LinkedIn's own team statements and 8–10 corroborating 2026 analyses of the new **360Brew** algorithm — cross-checked, not from a single video.

1. What Actually Changed (the “why”)

LinkedIn rebuilt ranking around an AI model called **360Brew** (~150B parameters), rolled out across most of the feed in late 2025–early 2026. Three shifts drive everything below:

- **Relationship Graph → Interest Graph.** Posts now reach people interested in your *topic*, not just your connections. Follower count no longer guarantees reach — great news for a small, niche profile.
- **Dwell time & meaningful comments are the currency.** A 3+ sentence comment is weighted ~15× a like. Posts held 60+ seconds get ~15.6% engagement vs ~1.2% for skim posts (13× gap). The first ~60 min is the test window.
- **Expertise/authority is scored.** 360Brew reads your headline, About, and post history together. When profile and posts tell the same story, it amplifies you to that topic's audience.

Quick benchmarks: external links ≈ **60% less reach** · document/PDF carousels are the top format (~6.6% engagement) · native video +36% YoY and reaches non-followers · personal profiles get ~65% of feed allocation vs ~5% for company pages.

2. Increase Your Connection-Request ACCEPTANCE Rate

Benchmark for 2026: a good acceptance rate is **30–45%**. Generic cold requests sit at 15–30%; personalized ones hit ~45%; engaging with someone's content *before* requesting pushes past **60%**.

Profile fixes (people check your profile before accepting)

- **Rewrite your headline for your buyer, not your résumé.** Current: “AI agents for CPG | Ex-Founder @ MAC Consultancy” — vague and backward-looking. Try:
 - “Helping CPG brands on Amazon & Walmart recover lost deductions & automate inventory | Ratio”
 - “I help Amazon/Walmart CPG brands stop leaking margin to retailer deductions | Ratio (free AI MCP)”
- Keep the keywords — **Amazon, Walmart, CPG, deductions, inventory** — they also drive search (you had only 13 search appearances; this is why).
- **Banner:** yours is good; add *who it's for* + a CTA: “For CPG brands on Amazon & Walmart → recover invalid deductions automatically. tryratio.io/mcp”. 67% of people leave banners blank.

- **About:** front-load the first 2 lines (all that shows before “see more”) with the problem you solve + a clear CTA, naturally seeded with your keywords.
- Your **SF Bay Area** location and **500+ connections** already add credibility — keep them.

Request behavior

- Always send a **personalized note under ~200 characters** (short beats maxing out 300). Reference *their* world.
- **Warm them first** — comment on 1–2 of their posts a day before requesting. Biggest single lever (to 60%+).
- **Target tightly:** founders / finance / supply-chain at brands selling on Amazon & Walmart. Ignored off-target requests lower your reputation score and weekly limit.

3. Get MORE People to Send YOU Requests (Inbound)

- **Post consistently in one lane.** The Interest Graph rewards topic consistency — own *finance / margin recovery for Amazon & Walmart CPG brands* (you’re a CA; almost no one combines AI + CPG retail finance). 3–5×/week.
- **Comment to be seen.** 15–20 min/day of 3+ sentence comments on bigger CPG/Amazon-seller creators. Their audience is your audience — this drives profile visits → inbound requests.
- **Make your profile a landing page** (Part 2) so a profile click converts to a connect/follow.
- **Turn on Creator mode / Follow** so not-yet-ready people can still follow and grow your topic audience.
- **Use the Featured section** to pin a high-value post or the free MCP.

4. Push Your Content to a US Audience

No “send to US” button exists, but these levers stack the odds:

- **Your location already signals US** (SF Bay Area) — biggest free win, already done.
- **Seed your golden hour with US engagement.** Post when the US is active (~8–9 AM and ~2–3 PM ET/PT, *not* IST). If first engagers are US-based, LinkedIn expands to more US users like them — the most controllable geo lever.
- **Build a US-weighted network** deliberately — connect with and comment on US CPG founders, Amazon/Walmart sellers, e-comm finance people.
- **Write for US context** — US retail terms, \$ figures, Amazon/Walmart US programs. 360Brew reads semantics and matches to US readers.
- **Engage in US-centric communities** (Amazon FBA, CPG, e-commerce finance) within their golden hour.
- **For guaranteed US reach,** run a small LinkedIn boost with geo = United States + job-title targeting — the only precise geo control LinkedIn offers.

5. Content & Format Playbook

Your posts are good but product-demo heavy. The algorithm now favors expertise/insight — aim for roughly **70% insight / 20% story / 10% product**.

- **Format priority:** (1) Document/PDF carousels, 6–9 slides (~6.6% engagement) · (2) Native vertical video 30–90s (reaches non-followers) · (3) Text + single image.

- **Avoid links in the post body** (~60% reach penalty). Put the link in your own first comment and reply to commenters.
- **Hook the first 2 lines** — that's all shown before "...see more" and it decides dwell time.
- **Write for comments:** end with a real question to your buyer. Reply to every comment within the first hour.
- **Your authority angle:** "CA who now builds AI for CPG retail finance." Post how Amazon/Walmart deductions work, the \$ brands lose, FBA reimbursement claims, SKU-level P&L — practical, numbers-driven.
- **Skip trend-chasing.** LinkedIn treats virality as a red flag internally; consistency + insight wins.

6. Your 2-Week Action Checklist

1. Rewrite headline + banner + first 2 lines of About with buyer-outcome language and keywords.
2. Pin your best post / the free MCP to Featured.
3. Switch posting time to US morning (ET or PT, wherever your buyers sit).
4. Post 3–5×/week, 70% insight on CPG retail finance; links in comments, not body.
5. Daily: 15–20 min of 3-sentence comments on US CPG/Amazon-seller creators before requesting.
6. Send ≤80–100 personalized, sub-200-char requests/week to tightly-targeted US people, warmed by a prior comment.
7. Reply to every comment within the golden hour.
8. After 2 weeks, boost your single best organic post with a small US-geo + job-title ad.

Sources

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